

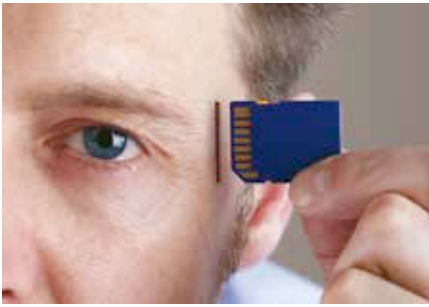
H+: The Digital Series

It is a web series that explores the possibilities of a futuristic world, where Transhumanism is mainstream <http://dgit.in/RPtILG>



The Singularity

Watch the man who defined transhumanism itself - an interview from Max More, touching everything transhuman <http://dgit.in/XOPLd9>



The possibilities are endless(ly scary)

our time on Earth, that many other species failed to come even close to. The technological aspect might be a relatively new kid on the block, but the search to find the 'key' to 'unlocking our potential' has gone on for centuries, and then some. The great legends of the Fountain of youth, the Elixir of life, and the ilk, along with all of our parallel 'superhero' universes just go on to show how much we love the idea of being inherently better than what we are today. So, in conclusion, Transhumanism is really just taking the process of evolution by the scruff of its neck, guiding it to make us what we want to become (in this lifetime), and tailoring our body, right from the micro-level gene mutations (which are actually more serious) to the macro body hacks like vision and sensory implants, or artificial limbs and such. This fast-tracking of the process – an override attempt at what we assume to be nature's work, and an endeavour at playing God with whatever power science has bestowed upon us – might not be the smartest move here. But, as a race, we've achieved so much success in the fields where we just dived in head-first, that this is really an incredibly logical step, if you think about it. We reached where we are by co-operating with nature in one way or the other. If we could really end up controlling it, the possibilities are nigh endless.

But you should probably avoid the agenda, because...

Of the potential suffering, on multiple levels. Let us take them one by one. First, the micro level - your level. Now, this is basically an experiment - there's no defined set of modifications that would make you a transhuman, or one that could, with any degree of certainty, put you on the road to posthumanism. Also, as with any

ongoing project, this might all fail, and the early adopters might be reduced to little more than roadside freakshows. Or at worst it might kill you with some as-of-yet undiscovered issues that the concept might spawn. There might be specific problems with specific transformations, too. Who knows, really? The point is, there's absolutely no point in jumping in, if many, many people don't jump into this together.

Then there's the bigger problem - the politicality of it all. Now, maybe it's just us, but any group that confer to themselves and their identities as "we transhumanists," "promoting the movement," "supporting the philosophy" and "ascribing to the worldview" smack of a community who consider themselves to be a cult. Not the best way to identify yourself, if you are hoping to eventually be a global phenomenon. Again, maybe it's just us, but cults are probably not the way forward. Not unless we want to be living in the dystopic cases that are painted with generous amounts of eerie in novels like George Orwell's 1984.



On a plus side, six-packs would probably be a push of a button away

Also, there is the 'community' part to be considered. The way that it is being propagated, the push is being made for every human to decide for himself the changes that he/she wants to implement over themselves. Not to say that choice is bad, but consider that this might cause such discrepancies throughout the community, that we might not remain compatible with each other. Obviously, money will play its part

WHERE WE'RE AT:

- A woman called Lepht Anonym has been implanting herself with mineral and metallic implants in order to feel electric and magnetic fields. She is confident of finding a way to sense the magnetic north soon.
- Researchers have discovered that life can actually be used as a raw material for development. They've created a human ear from bovine (cow) tissues, which was 'cultivated' on a rodent.
- Artists have found novelty in modifying the human form. Surgeries, robotic third arms, flesh-hook suspensions and prosthetics commonplace in some circles.
- People have been implanting themselves with magnets, just so that they can get metallic objects attracted to their body. Even we're stumped about the "why" of it all.

too. And we all know that when money comes into the consideration, any prevalent sense of it being a level playing field is vanished. Now, this world, already horrifically crooked towards the rich, would be out of reach for the mango people. Nothing, from academics to art or sports would remain sacred. A transhuman (billionaire, of course) Mr. Burns could slash Usain Bolt's record of the fastest 100m time, assuming that Mr. Bolt does not throw comparable money upon himself too. Then there are more basic things to consider - things like reproduction, social harmony, world peace, and what not. Come to think of it, a planet full of futuristic, ageless Greek Gods would have a hard time controlling the population, energy requirements, law and order, and everything else that ties our social fabric together. Off the top of our heads, the sort of issues that seemingly arise would require the kind of poise and finesse for their handling that we haven't really seen our leaders display in recent times... or ever. And this is when they are ruling plain old humans. Controlling a population of superhumans might be a different proposition altogether. We're not saying that we're entirely against the concept. We just think that meeting up in closed circles, and in dark political undertones is not the way to do it. Maybe we should give it a little more time, let it sort out some of its issues. Just food for thought. Lots of food for some serious thought... **4**